



THE PROS AND CONS OF CLOUD COMPUTING

Cloud computing is often touted as the future of business and enterprise technology. Like everything else, cloud computing has its own pros and cons. This article discusses the advantages and disadvantages of using the cloud, and gives a brief overview of various open source cloud computing technologies.

Cloud computing is a term used to describe a new class of network based computing that takes place over the Internet. These platforms hide the complexity and details of the underlying infrastructure from users and applications by providing a very simple graphical interface.

Clouds are transparent to users and applications and they can be built in multiple ways. In general, they are built on clusters of PC servers combined with in-house applications and systems software.

Cloud computing enables companies and applications that are dependent on the system infrastructure to remain infrastructure-less and, instead, use the cloud infrastructure on a 'pay as used' basis; thereby, the companies can save capital and operational investments.

Clients can put their data and applications on the cloud instead of on their own desktop PCs or their own servers. Also, they can use the servers within the cloud to do processing, data manipulation, etc.